



HM Courts &
Tribunals Service

Form

How to apply for probate by post if there is a will

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This publication is available at <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/form-pa1p-apply-for-probate-the-deceased-had-a-will/how-to-apply-for-probate-by-post-if-there-is-a-will>

Who can apply

You can apply if you are one of the following:

- an 'executor' – a person named in a will of the person who's died (grant of probate)
- a 'beneficiary' where there's a will but none of the executors are applying (letters of administration with will annexed)
- a probate practitioner representing the executors or the beneficiaries if there are no executors (grant of probate or letters of administration with will annexed)

Apply as an executor without a probate practitioner

Download the 'citizen applicants only' form to apply by post.

Alternatively, you can [apply for probate online \(https://www.gov.uk/applying-for-probate/apply-for-probate\)](https://www.gov.uk/applying-for-probate/apply-for-probate).

You may also be able to apply using this form if:

- you are a beneficiary named in the will, and there are no executors able to apply for the grant
- if there are no executors named in the will

Apply as a probate practitioner

Download the 'probate practitioners only' form to apply by post.

Alternatively, you can [apply online \(https://www.gov.uk/guidance/register-for-myhmcts-online-case-management-for-legal-professionals\)](https://www.gov.uk/guidance/register-for-myhmcts-online-case-management-for-legal-professionals) if you or your practice has a MyHMCTS account.

Before you apply

You'll need to:

- [report the value of the estate \(https://www.gov.uk/valuing-estate-of-someone-who-died/tell-hmrc-estate-value\)](https://www.gov.uk/valuing-estate-of-someone-who-died/tell-hmrc-estate-value) of the person who died to HM Revenue and Customs
- [pay any inheritance tax \(https://www.gov.uk/paying-inheritance-tax\)](https://www.gov.uk/paying-inheritance-tax) due

How to apply

1. Download the correct paper form.
2. Fill in all sections that apply.
3. Complete the checklist.
4. Print the form.
5. Sign and date the application.
6. Include a cheque with your application (see [How to pay](#)).
7. Send your completed form and supporting documents.

Where to send your application

If you're applying as an administrator without a probate practitioner, send your completed form and supporting documents to:

HMCTS Probate
PO Box 12625
Harlow
CM20 9QE

If you're applying as a probate practitioner, send your completed form and supporting documents to:

Newcastle District Probate Registry
2nd Floor
Kings Court
Earl Grey Way
North Shields
NE29 6AR

What to include in your application

The original will

You will need to submit the original will and the official death certificate. Photocopies of these documents will not be accepted.

The original will become a public document by law when HM Courts and Tribunals Services (HMCTS) gives you the grant. It will not be returned to you, as HMCTS must store it in the public records.

How to pay

You must pay by sending a cheque payable to 'HM Courts and Tribunals Service' with your documents.

How long it will take

It can take up to 12 weeks to process your application if there's no delay in receiving your documents.

Contact us

If you have not heard from us after 12 weeks or need help to complete this form, you can contact us.

Probate helpline
Telephone: 0300 303 0648
Monday to Friday, 9am to 1pm
Closed on weekends and bank holidays

[Find out about call charges \(https://www.gov.uk/call-charges\)](https://www.gov.uk/call-charges)

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